



Element A - An Introduction to the Problem

Remember that someone who does not know the situation should be able to understand Element A after reading what you have written.

A1 Problem Identification

A problem that a primary stakeholder is asking us to help with is creating a board game to give students another thing to do. This school has limited options for board games and collaborative games. Many students are looking for ways to meet people and have fun. Creating a board game gives students the opportunity to have fun with others without requiring screens. The media center, led by Ms. Tatro is the main area for students to gather and play games, for example the media center provides a PS5.

A3 Problem Elaboration

Many students don't use the media center and are glued to their phones. Our project can help create an environment where students have other ways to enjoy themselves. Screens and technology tend to isolate people and can have positive and negative effects on teens, so getting a break from the screen can be positive for students.

A4 Concern of Primary Stakeholders

Primary stakeholder : Students

Role: Students will be the people actually playing the game

Concerns: There are some concerns with students using the game. Not all students are respectful of objects and tend to destroy items around the school. Students can also easily

turn the board game into a weapon because it is made of wood. Finally, there is a possibility students won't use the game, which would get rid of the point of the game.

Secondary stakeholder; Ms. Tanro

Role: The person who controls what happens in the media center and the one we will need to get approval from.

Concerns:

1. She might disprove of the game
2. Might not advertise the game
3. Worried students may not play it

A5 and A6 Problem Justification

Board games bring people closer, strengthen relationships, and can help you meet new people. Board games can also help people learn important social skills such as waiting, turn taking, sharing, how to cope with losing, making conversation, problem solving, compromising, collaborating and being flexible. A 2017 study suggests playing board games can help lower stress and increase feelings of calmness. All of these skills and experiences are important for teenagers going through adolescence. Usage of screens and technology on the other hand, while providing opportunities and entertainment for teens, can lead to many negative things. For example, many people look at their phones in a slouched over position, Gregory Hahn, M.D., says that he has seen "trending increase of neck and back pain in kids in his more than 20 years of practicing medicine." An abundant amount of screen time can also have a toll on mental health. By having less screens and more board games, we can create an environment that can have only positive effects.

Sources:

<https://www.ashevilleenc.gov/news/wellness-wednesday-5-mental-benefits-of-board-games/>

<https://manhattanpsychologygroup.com/MPG-blog/benefits-board-games/>

<https://www.hopkinsmedicine.org/health/wellness-and-prevention/screen-time-side-effects-in-kids-and-teens>

Record your References in this text box. - MLA format

If you interview someone call it "Personal Communication" for citations:

Adults - Use full name, and profession, including if they are a stakeholder or an expert.

Student or under 18 - Use Initials or "Student 1" and include grade and school.

Student 1 - ST

Would you like to have board games and activities in the media center?

"Yes, because it would fun to play in the free time"

Have you ever used any of the things provided in the library currently?

"No, there isn't much time and I don't know anything that's in there"

Do you often play board games in your own free time?

"Yes"

What kind of games/accommodations would you like to see in the media center?

"Chess and other competitive games"